

James Gower

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Professional Summary

Highly motivated and self-directed Software Developer with a solid foundation in computing systems and a proven track record of building production-ready applications. Experienced in full-stack development, e-commerce integration, and dynamic database management, with a practical focus on the React ecosystem, Stripe, and PostgreSQL. Combines technical engineering discipline and modern AI-augmented development workflows with strong client-facing communication skills, making for a highly efficient, adaptable, and collaborative team member.

Key Skills

- **Frontend Development:** React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), TanStack Query, Redux/RTK, responsive/mobile-first UI/UX, Google Analytics 4, SEO.
- **Backend & Databases:** Node.js, Next.js API routes, PostgreSQL, Prisma ORM, database design, RESTful APIs, Zod validation, authentication/role-based access (JWT/Oauth), Nodemailer/Handlebars email (SMTP).
- **Cloud, DevOps & AI Tooling:** Stripe (payments, subscriptions, webhooks), AWS (SES), reCAPTCHA, Git, CI/CD, Vitest, React Testing Library, AI-assisted development (GitHub Copilot, Cursor, LLM refactoring), Playwright E2E, Vercel/Railway/Render.
- **Project & Site Management:** Full SDLC, agile workflows, booking/scheduling systems, membership management, admin dashboards, GDPR compliance.
- **Professional & Collaborative Skills:** Client requirement gathering, user-focused problem solving, cross-functional teamwork, translating business ideas into production applications.

Technical Experience

Lead Full-Stack Developer | The Short Grass | <https://theshortgrass.jamesgower.dev> | 2025 – 2026

- **Full-Stack Architecture:** Engineered a production-ready, commercial-grade MVP booking platform designed for a planned retail venue, implementing an end-to-end architecture from a responsive MUI front-end to a PostgreSQL database.
- **Concurrent Scheduling Engine:** Engineered a robust PostgreSQL + Prisma scheduling system that actively manages bay capacity and prevents overlapping reservations under real-time concurrent user traffic.
- **Secure Auth & Payments:** Integrated Stripe (Payment Intents, webhooks, subscriptions) alongside NextAuth (OAuth/JWT) to support guest checkouts, secure user sessions, and role-based admin dashboards.
- **Testing & Deployment:** Leveraged local LLM workflows to rapidly generate documentation and tests (Vitest, Playwright E2E), drastically reducing boilerplate testing setup while maintaining strict code coverage and GDPR compliance.

Lead Developer | Francesca Jade Creates | 2020 – 2021

- **Serverless E-Commerce Platform:** Built a production-ready React + TypeScript storefront on AWS Amplify with AppSync GraphQL, DynamoDB, and S3.
- **Payments & Automation:** Integrated Stripe Checkout + webhooks with Lambda to process orders, update payment/shipping data, and trigger transactional emails.
- **Secure Auth & Admin:** Implemented AWS Cognito-based authentication and role-based admin access for protected product/order management.
- **Testing & Delivery:** Maintained code quality with Jest/React Testing Library and shipped via a Webpack/Babel cloud deployment pipeline.

Additional Experience

Assistant Site Manager | Cage Green Primary School | 2016 – 2020

- **Facility Logistics:** Managed site operations, including contractor scheduling, supply chain oversight, and preventative maintenance workflows.
- **Operational Continuity:** Entrusted to take full operational control of the facility during an unplanned, long-term management medical absence; maintained strict regulatory compliance and zero downtime
- **Resource Management:** Coordinated multi-stakeholder projects and rotating shift patterns to maintain high-performance standards in a fast-paced environment.

Postman | Royal Mail | 2022 – 2025

- **Logistics & Delivery:** Optimised high-volume, time-sensitive delivery routes to meet strict service windows during peak demand.
- **Data & Asset Security:** Maintained end-to-end chain of custody for sensitive documentation and high-value shipments, ensuring full protocol compliance.
- **Performance Accountability:** Delivered consistent, target-driven results in an autonomous role requiring high attention to detail.

Education & Qualifications

HNC in Computing | West Kent College | *Graduated: July 2016*

Core Modules: Computer Systems, Systems Analysis & Design, Website Design, Database Design Concepts, Object-Oriented Programming (Java), and Networking Technologies.

Extended Diploma in ICT Practitioners | West Kent College | *Graduated: July 2014*

Core Modules: Event-Driven Programming, Software Design & Development, and Client-Side Customisation of Web Pages.

GCSEs | Hayesbrook School for Boys | *Graduated: July 2012*

10 GCSEs at Grades A*–C, including Mathematics, English Literature, English Language, Chemistry, Physics, ICT, and Philosophy.

References

Available upon request.